



THE INSTITUTE OF CHARTERED ACCOUNTANTS OF INDIA
(Set up by an Act of Parliament)

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WEB-MEDIA POLICY DOCUMENT OF BRANCHES OF ICAI



**THE INSTITUTE OF CHARTERED
ACCOUNTANTS OF INDIA, NEW DELHI**

12-06-2020



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BACKGROUND

The Institute of Chartered Accountants of India (ICAI) is a statutory body established by an Act of Parliament, viz. The Chartered Accountants Act, 1949 (Act No. XXXVIII of 1949) for regulating the profession of Chartered Accountancy in the country. The ICAI is the second largest professional body of Chartered Accountants in the world, with a strong tradition of service to the Indian economy in public interest. ICAI is having a network of 5 Regional offices and 164 Branches.

Over the years, the contribution of Websites has increased significantly towards the engagement of ICAI Stakeholders i.e. Students and Members with ICAI. Today, these technologies are being used by everyone in their day-to-day activities and are helping our Students and Members to avail different services from their doorsteps.

All Regional offices and Branches also have their web presence through different websites, webpages and apps developed by them. These websites, webpages and apps offer information and services to one and all. However, varied nomenclatures, different layout standards, navigation strategies as well as different technologies are impacting brand and also the efficiency and effectiveness of the use of web platform and resources.

ICAI functioning is oriented towards common framework for its Regional Councils and Branch in various aspects. In respect of websites the Central Committees, Regional Councils, Branches and Chapters of ICAI are maintaining their separate websites and other media. This policy document seeks to enable a common framework for the website and other web-media of all arms of ICAI, which should be followed in letter and spirit

The web-media may be the following:

- Website
- Facebook
- Twitter
- Linked
- You-Tube
- Other Social Media Pages
- Mobile applications (Mobile apps).



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All the Branches of the ICAI, having (seeking to have) or maintaining any web-media, are required to follow this policy in letter and spirit.

I. **BRANCH WEB SITE**

1. **Website and Domain Name**

- a. The Branches of ICAI may have their own independent website.
- b. Such independent website has to be linked at its related Regional Council website and ICAI's main website i.e. www.icaai.org
- c. The domain name of ICAI Branch website shall be subdomain of icaai.org
- d. The names should be uniform. For e.g. the name of a **Branch** WEB site should **www.<Location of the Branch>.icaai.org**. For example, the name of the **WEB** Site of **Hyderabad Branch** should be www.hyderabad.icaai.org

2. **Designing**

- a. While designing and/or publishing the site, it would be the responsibility of the Managing Committee of the Branch concerned that the guidelines applicable are followed strictly.
- b. Branch Websites shall be in sync with ICAI.ORG (Logo, Colour, Font and Design).
- c. Template – The Branches while designing their website should follow the Template of given as per annexure to this policy
- d. Colour scheme for Website – The Branch Websites should follow the colour schema for their website:
 - i. Background should be white or any other shade of White.
 - ii. Text Colour and Section Colours to be used in the Website should be chosen between shades of colours Blue, Green and Yellow by the Branches.



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3. Policy / Guidelines Adherence

- a. Branch Websites should be within the ambit of this Policy Document and no deviation whatsoever is allowed.
- b. Branches are also required to adhere to the guidelines issued by ICAI head office, Regional Council from time to time including related to Election Code of Conduct, etc.

4. Regional Council

- a. A Branch has to provide the following details to the Regional Council for updating the same on the Micro page of the Branch maintained on the website of the Regional Council (if the website is maintained by the RC):
 - i. Names of members of the Management Committee (MC)
 - ii. Year to which it relates
 - iii. Designation, of the MC members, if any
 - iv. Contact details of the Branch
 - v. Upcoming events, if any.
- b. Where a branch is maintaining a separate website, a link thereof should be available on the said Micro page maintained on the website of the Regional Council.

5. Content

A Branch's separate website (if maintained) may contain any of the following content in their respective websites on their Home Page or Landing Page(s): -

- a. Details of the Branch Managing committee for the Current Term only.
- b. Branch Chairperson Message which is Updated
- c. Section related to Members having links connected to members – Hyperlinked to Members Tab of ICAI.org
- d. Section related to Students having links connected to students– Hyperlinked to Students Tab of ICAI.org
- e. Latest Announcement section - Hyperlinked to Announcements Tab of ICAI.org
- f. Latest Events section about events happening in Branch / City separately for Members and Students.



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- g. Section related to Newsletters – only if it is updated regularly - While doing so, it should be ensured that no advertisements/ appearing in the Newsletter should be published in the site. Photographs appearing in the Newsletter or otherwise should not be published in the Website. The newsletter should be as per the guidelines issued by the Council and respective committee
- h. Various Resources Link linked to Resources Tab of ICAI.org
- i. Updated Contact Us section
- j. Photo allowed on Home Page should be as per template and only as follows:
 - i. Only 1 Group Photo allowed of Branch Managing Committee.
 - ii. 1 Photo of Branch Premises
 - iii. 1 Branch Chairperson Photo
 - iv. Photos of President, Vice President, CCM/RCM of that Region, Branch Managing Committee Members in rolling mode or gallery mode, however only one photo shall be visible at a time on the home page.
- k. Photos may be posted in a separate Photo Gallery Section, wherein only event Related Photos and other photos are uploaded.
- l. Links useful for Members and Students should be hyperlinked to Quick Links section on ICAI Website
- m. Job Vacancies for Articles and Members for that Branch City
- n. Members' Directory – The Branch websites can host the Members' Directory of that Branch. But same should be accessible only to the Members under the Jurisdiction of that Branch either through a Password Protected file or through a Separate Login Mechanism available to Members.
- o. Technical Updates, News and Laws useful to Members pertaining to only that Particular Branch / City.
- p. Paper Presentations any other material disseminated during Conferences or Seminars held in the Branch are allowed to be hosted on the Branch Website with due disclaimer that the views expressed in this presentation are of the Speaker himself/herself. The Institute of Chartered Accountants of India does not subscribe to his/her views.
- q. The Branch Websites should host the following links on their Home Page on a mandatory basis:



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- i. ICAI.org website link - <https://www.icai.org/>
- ii. Particular Regional Council Website of that Region
- r. The Branches should prominently display the **ICAI Social Media Links** on its homepage:
 - i. FACEBOOK - <https://www.facebook.com/theicai>
 - ii. TWITTER - <https://twitter.com/theicai>
 - iii. LINKEDIN - <https://www.linkedin.com/edu/22460>
 - iv. YOUTUBE - <https://www.youtube.com/icaiorgtube>
 - v. INSTAGRAM - <https://www.instagram.com/icaiorg/>
- s. Prominent Links to these links may be posted on the website
 - i. Self Service Portal <https://eservices.icai.org>
 - ii. Digital Learning Hub - <https://learning.icai.org>
 - iii. eServices - https://www.icai.org/new_post.html?post_id=5509
 - iv. CDS - <https://icai-cds.org/>
 - v. ICAI Social Media - <https://www.icai.org/followus>
 - vi. ICAI Mobile App - <https://www.icai.org/mobile/>
 - vii. eSahaayataa - <https://www.icai.org/help/>
 - viii. ICAI TV - <http://icaitv.com/>

6. Costs

- a. The WEB site be created by the Branch should be on borne by the respective branch
- b. In case the Branch Website does not meet the criteria as per this policy, no cost thereof shall be allowed to be debited to the Branch Accounts.

7. Advertisements

- a. Publishing advertisement(s) on the Website is not permitted within the overall guidelines prescribed

8. Technology

- a. Any open source technology latest supported version should be used for development of Website. Websites to be hosted on secured cloud platform only.

9. Links / Pop-up

- a. Broken links are not allowed on Branch Websites



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- b. No Pop-Up is allowed on Website

10. Website Management Team

- a. Branch management committee should ensure that Branch Website Committee is formed at local level to manage Branch Website and contents are regularly updated.
- b. Chairman or Vice Chairman of Branch shall be Chairman of Website Management team.
- c. It would be the responsibility of the Respective Branch Committee and the respective Regional Council that the Branch Website, if any is updated regularly.

11. Withdrawal of Website

- a. No other information should be published which is outside the purview of this policy.
- b. In case deviations are found, permission to have Website could be withdrawn.

II. FACEBOOK

A Branch is not allowed to have any Facebook page

III. TWITTER

A Branch is not allowed to have any Twitter page

IV. LINKEDIN

A Branch is not allowed to have any LinkedIn page

V. YOU-TUBE

1. A Branch is allowed to maintain only one YouTube Account.
2. The naming convention for the YouTube Account will be as follows: <Branch Name> Branch of <Region> of ICAI. E.g. Ahmedabad Branch of WIRC of ICAI.
3. The link of Branch YouTube Channel, if any should be on the Branch Website's Home Page.



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4. The same policy applies to CA Student Associations such as NICASA, WICASA etc of that Branch. They are also allowed to have only their Separate YouTube Channel which has to be linked to Branch's Website.

VI. OTHER SOCIAL MEDIA PAGES

The Branches are not allowed to have any other Social Media Pages on any other platform or any New Platform.

VII. MOBILE APPLICATIONS (MOBILE APPS)

The Branches are not allowed to maintain any separate Mobile App.

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Approved by (Management Committee)	
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Annexure: Sample Template of Branch website Home Page

ICAI.ORG		REGIONAL WEBSITE	
 BRANCH OF INDIA REGIONAL COUNCIL OF THE INSTITUTE OF CHARTERED ACCOUNTANTS OF INDIA ABOUT US MEMBERS STUDENTS			
<<Banner>>			
Branch Management Committee	Resources	NewsLetters	Quick Links
Photo Gallery			
CHAIRMAN'S MESSAGE	Announcement	UseFul Links/Vacancy	UPCOMING EVENTS MEMBERS STUDENTS